Final Fantasy Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

MTGNET

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Dataset Snapshot

This run on Final Fantasy uses 173,242 unique deck builds and 769,659 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 11 learned archetypes. Card win rates are games-in-hand (GIH) win rates; an archetype's win rate is over all of its games. The best-performing large shells are White Base | Magitek Infantry / Gaelicat, Izzet | Sahagin / Blazing Bomb, Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and standalone bombs.

How to Read This Report

- **Coreness** measures how central a card is to an archetype: played in many of its decks, characteristic of it, and connected to the rest of the deck. Cards are grouped into Core, Support and Periphery rings. A core card may carry a tag: **signature** (in bold: played in at least 15% of this archetype's decks and in at most one other archetype at that rate) or *staple* (at least 25% of this archetype's decks and at least 15% in three or more archetypes); untagged core cards are neither.
- **Play rate** is the share of the archetype's decks that play at least one copy.
- **Bombs** are cards that are strong on their own. A bomb's **lift** compares, within the decks that play it, the win rate when the card is in hand with the win rate when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, and is shrunk across archetypes; it is shown in percentage points (pp). Bombs are listed whatever ring they sit in: core and support bombs keep their ring on the site, and only bombs that would otherwise be peripheral go to the bomb island beside the rings.
- A **synergy pair** wins more often when both cards are drawn than their separate effects predict (games-in-hand, adjusted for game length and play/draw). The effect λ is an interaction log-odds, shown as a percentage change in the odds of winning with its 95% confidence interval. Pairs are tested with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control: *verified* means $q \leq 0.10$, *tentative* means $q \leq 0.25$. Few pairs pass; an absent pair means "not detectable with this data", not "no synergy".
- **Payoff** and **engine** roles are decided by synergy arrows only: the synergy pairs (verified or tentative) whose direction is significant. In such a pair the arrow points from the payoff, the

card that wins more when drawn without its partner, to the engine it rewards; a card whose arrows mostly point out of it is a payoff, one whose arrows mostly point into it an engine. The arrow reflects each card's standalone strength within the pair, not a direction of the synergy itself. Played-together links carry the same arrow on the site as context only; they do not set roles.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
White Base | Magitek Infantry / Gaelicat	9,445	43,162	59.52%	Magitek Infantry, Gaelicat, White Mage's Staff, Slash of Light, Paladin's Arms
Izzet | Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	25,277	116,487	56.87%	Sahagin, Blazing Bomb, Shantotto, Tactician Magician, Call the Mountain Chocobo, Retrieve the Esper
Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements	22,191	100,486	56.48%	Town Greeter, Shinra Reinforcements, Cloud of Darkness, Fight On!, Exdeath, Void Warlock
Boros | Weapons Vendor / Giott, King of the Dwarves	12,351	54,986	55.91%	Weapons Vendor, Giott, King of the Dwarves, Item Shopkeep, Zidane, Tantalus Thief, Warrior's Sword
Orzhov | Judge Magister Gabranth / Rufus Shinra	13,357	59,534	55.78%	Judge Magister Gabranth, Rufus Shinra, Dwarven Castle Guard, White Auracite, Ahriman
Selesnya | Rinoa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	10,532	45,883	55.38%	Rinoa Heartilly, Garnet, Princess of Alexandria, Summon: Choco/Mog, Summon: Fat Chocobo, Bard's Bow
Dimir | Locke Cole / Ultimecia, Time Sorceress	20,145	89,518	55.16%	Locke Cole, Ultimecia, Time Sorceress, Dreams of Laguna, Dragoon's Wyvern, Sephiroth's Intervention
Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	21,476	92,565	54.88%	Ignis Scientia, Omega, Heartless Evolution, Town Greeter, Travel the Overworld, Prishe's Wanderings
Rakdos | Garland, Knight of Cornelia / Mysidian Elder	13,823	60,323	54.71%	Garland, Knight of Cornelia, Mysidian Elder, Black Mage's Rod, Cornered by Black Mages, Black Waltz No. 3

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Azorius | Cid, Timeless Artificer / Rook Turret	14,843	64,825	54.66%	Cid, Timeless Artificer, Rook Turret, Sage's Nouliths, Gaelicat, White Auracite
Gruul | Gladiolus Amicitia / Rydia, Summoner of Mist	9,802	41,890	53.20%	Gladiolus Amicitia, Rydia, Summoner of Mist, Gysahl Greens, Summon: Fat Chocobo, Chocobo Kick

2 Core of Each Archetype

The core ring of each archetype, most central first, with the share of the archetype's decks that play each card and its tag where it has one: **signature** (in bold) or staple. The second line lists the archetype's bombs, whatever ring they sit in: cards that are strong on their own, with their lift (in-hand vs in-library win rate within the decks that play them, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes) and their games in hand.

Archetype	Core cards (play rate)
Izzet 25,277 decks	**Blazing Bomb** (51%, signature), Sahagin (68%, staple), **Shantotto, Tactician Magician** (50%, signature), Call the Mountain Chocobo (56%, staple), Retrieve the Esper (58%, staple), **The Emperor of Palamecia** (49%, signature), Thunder Magic (57%, staple), Light of Judgment (41%, staple), Ice Magic (62%, staple), Ultros, Obnoxious Octopus (36%, staple) *Bombs:* Kefka, Court Mage (+8.1 pp, 2,373 games); Nibelheim Aflame (+7.6 pp, 3,114 games); Urza, Lord High Artificer (+7.2 pp, 530 games); Choco-Comet (+6.1 pp, 18,112 games)
Golgari 22,191 decks	Shinra Reinforcements (55%, staple), Town Greeter (64%, staple), **Cloud of Darkness** (47%, signature), Fight On! (52%, staple), **Exdeath, Void Warlock** (41%, signature), Gran Pulse Ochu (44%, staple), Chocobo Kick (48%, staple), Resentful Revelation (54%, staple), Balamb T-Rexaur (51%, staple), Goobbue Gardener (48%, staple) *Bombs:* Ardyn, the Usurper (+9.6 pp, 5,531 games); Sazh Katzroy (+8.5 pp, 4,113 games); Gix, Yawgmoth Praetor (+7.5 pp, 506 games); Sephiroth, Fabled SOLDIER (+7.5 pp, 1,497 games)
Simic 21,476 decks	Town Greeter (55%, staple), **Omega, Heartless Evolution** (43%, signature), **Ignis Scientia** (50%, signature), **Travel the Overworld** (32%, signature), Goobbue Gardener (44%, staple), Chocobo Kick (45%, staple), Prishe's Wanderings (40%, staple), Summon: Fat Chocobo (42%, staple), **Qiqirn Merchant** (33%, signature), Balamb T-Rexaur (45%, staple) *Bombs:* Ardyn, the Usurper (+9.0 pp, 1,311 games); Sazh Katzroy (+8.4 pp, 4,391 games); Yuna, Hope of Spira (+7.6 pp, 969 games); Nibelheim Aflame (+7.2 pp, 453 games)

Archetype	Core cards (play rate)
Dimir 20,145 decks	Dreams of Laguna (54%, staple), Sahagin (47%, staple), **Locke Cole** (41%, signature), **Ultimecia, Time Sorceress** (34%, signature), Cornered by Black Mages (44%, staple), Hecteyes (44%, staple), Combat Tutorial (52%, staple), Resentful Revelation (43%, staple), Ice Magic (53%, staple), Vayne's Treachery (51%, staple) *Bombs:* Ardyn, the Usurper (+8.9 pp, 4,729 games); Kefka, Court Mage (+8.5 pp, 2,437 games); Sazh Katzroy (+7.8 pp, 471 games); Kuja, Genome Sorcerer (+7.7 pp, 2,414 games)
Azorius 14,843 decks	Gaelicat (52%, staple), **Rook Turret** (42%, signature), Sage's Nouliths (45%, staple), White Mage's Staff (52%, staple), White Auracite (58%, staple), **Valkyrie Aerial Unit** (33%, signature), **Cid, Timeless Artificer** (41%, signature), **Tidus, Blitzball Star** (36%, signature), **Cargo Ship** (27%, signature), Paladin's Arms (46%, staple) *Bombs:* Urza, Lord High Artificer (+8.6 pp, 822 games); Jill, Shiva's Dominant (+6.5 pp, 2,982 games); Akroma's Will (+6.5 pp, 351 games); Adeline, Resplendent Cathar (+6.3 pp, 346 games)
Rakdos 13,823 decks	**Mysidian Elder** (51%, signature), Black Mage's Rod (62%, staple), Cornered by Black Mages (60%, staple), Suplex (50%, staple), Circle of Power (31%, staple), Call the Mountain Chocobo (40%, staple), Red Mage's Rapier (26%, staple), **Queen Brahne** (25%, signature), **Black Waltz No. 3** (34%, signature), Thunder Magic (53%, staple) *Bombs:* Kuja, Genome Sorcerer (+11.7 pp, 5,994 games); Kefka, Court Mage (+8.3 pp, 1,181 games); Ardyn, the Usurper (+7.5 pp, 2,216 games); Yawgmoth, Thran Physician (+7.4 pp, 375 games)
Orzhov 13,357 decks	**Rufus Shinra** (44%, signature), White Mage's Staff (48%, staple), Dwarven Castle Guard (40%, staple), Undercity Dire Rat (43%, staple), **Judge Magister Gabranth** (47%, signature), Hecteyes (46%, staple), Black Mage's Rod (43%, staple), White Auracite (50%, staple), Slash of Light (38%, staple), Ahriman (43%, staple) *Bombs:* Dion, Bahamut's Dominant (+10.7 pp, 2,698 games); Squall, SeeD Mercenary (+7.9 pp, 4,928 games); Ardyn, the Usurper (+7.5 pp, 2,170 games); Sephiroth, Fabled SOLDIER (+7.2 pp, 1,533 games)
Boros 12,351 decks	Warrior's Sword (57%, staple), Paladin's Arms (59%, staple), Weapons Vendor (58%, staple), **Item Shopkeep** (45%, signature), White Mage's Staff (57%, staple), Slash of Light (52%, staple), Gaelicat (48%, staple), **Giott, King of the Dwarves** (47%, signature), **Freya Crescent** (34%, signature), **Zidane, Tantalus Thief** (43%, signature) *Bombs:* Dion, Bahamut's Dominant (+10.8 pp, 2,034 games); Samurai's Katana (+9.0 pp, 10,210 games); Winota, Joiner of Forces (+8.1 pp, 605 games); Bruse Tarl, Boorish Herder (+8.1 pp, 604 games)
Selesnya 10,532 decks	Summon: Fat Chocobo (59%, staple), Summon: Choco/Mog (50%, staple), **Garnet, Princess of Alexandria** (45%, signature), Bard's Bow (47%, staple), **Rinoa Heartilly** (50%, signature), White Auracite (53%, staple), Gysahl Greens (38%, staple), White Mage's Staff (43%, staple), Aerith Rescue Mission (27%, staple), Slash of Light (41%, staple) *Bombs:* Dion, Bahamut's Dominant (+12.0 pp, 1,928 games); Sazh Katzroy (+9.0 pp, 2,313 games); Esper Origins (+8.8 pp, 2,052 games); Yuna, Hope of Spira (+7.5 pp, 1,994 games)

Archetype	Core cards (play rate)
Gruul 9,802 decks	Gysahl Greens (53%, staple), Summon: Fat Chocobo (61%, staple), **Rydia, Summoner of Mist** (40%, signature), **Gladiolus Amicitia** (50%, signature), Prishe's Wanderings (49%, staple), Call the Mountain Chocobo (55%, staple), Summon: G.F. Ifrit (35%, staple), Chocobo Kick (59%, staple), Goobbue Gardener (50%, staple), **Sidequest: Raise a Chocobo** (28%, signature) *Bombs:* Sazh Katzroy (+8.7 pp, 2,047 games); Nibelheim Aflame (+8.3 pp, 901 games); Yuna, Hope of Spira (+7.2 pp, 432 games); Dion, Bahamut's Dominant (+6.8 pp, 387 games)
White Base 9,445 decks	Paladin's Arms (57%, staple), Slash of Light (61%, staple), White Mage's Staff (69%, staple), Gaelicat (66%, staple), You're Not Alone (46%, staple), Weapons Vendor (45%, staple), Magitek Infantry (96%, staple), Dragoon's Lance (37%, staple), Adelbert Steiner (31%, staple), White Auracite (61%, staple) *Bombs:* Dion, Bahamut's Dominant (+9.6 pp, 1,933 games); Ardyn, the Usurper (+8.6 pp, 275 games); Sazh Katzroy (+8.1 pp, 285 games); Akroma's Will (+6.9 pp, 302 games)

3 What Defines the Best Shells

White Base | Magitek Infantry / Gaelicat

This cluster contains 9,445 decks across 43,162 games and posts a baseline win rate of 59.52%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is Paladin's Arms (57% of decks), Slash of Light (61% of decks), White Mage's Staff (69% of decks), Gaelicat (66% of decks), You're Not Alone (46% of decks). Its defining signposts are Magitek Infantry, Gaelicat, White Mage's Staff, Slash of Light, Paladin's Arms, White Auracite.

Bombs that win on their own here: Dion, Bahamut's Dominant (+9.6 pp), Ardyn, the Usurper (+8.6 pp), Sazh Katzroy (+8.1 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 1 are verified synergies (BH q $\leq$ 0.10) and 2 tentative (q $\leq$ 0.25). The strongest verified pair is Adelbert Steiner + Dragoon's Lance: +31% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+12, +54]%, 1,067 games).

Izzet | Sahagin / Blazing Bomb

This cluster contains 25,277 decks across 116,487 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.87%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is Blazing Bomb (51% of decks), Sahagin (68% of decks), Shantotto, Tactician Magician (50% of decks), Call the Mountain Chocobo (56% of decks), Retrieve the Esper (58% of decks). Its defining signposts are Sahagin, Blazing Bomb, Shantotto, Tactician Magician, Call the Mountain Chocobo, Retrieve the Esper, The Emperor of Palamecia.

Bombs that win on their own here: Kefka, Court Mage (+8.1 pp), Nibelheim Aflame (+7.6 pp), Urza, Lord High Artificer (+7.2 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 13 are verified synergies (BH q $\leq$ 0.10) and 16 tentative (q $\leq$ 0.25). The strongest verified pair is Call the Mountain Chocobo + Ultros, Obnoxious Octopus: +16% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+9, +24]%, 6,705 games). Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the payoffs (cards

that win more when drawn than their partners) are Sahagin, Suplex, Thunder Magic and the engines they reward are Light of Judgment, Retrieve the Esper, Sorceress's Schemes.

Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements

This cluster contains 22,191 decks across 100,486 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.48%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is Shinra Reinforcements (55% of decks), Town Greeter (64% of decks), Cloud of Darkness (47% of decks), Fight On! (52% of decks), Exdeath, Void Warlock (41% of decks). Its defining signposts are Town Greeter, Shinra Reinforcements, Cloud of Darkness, Fight On!, Exdeath, Void Warlock, Resentful Revelation.

Bombs that win on their own here: Ardyn, the Usurper (+9.6 pp), Sazh Katzroy (+8.5 pp), Gix, Yawgmoth Praetor (+7.5 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 16 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 14 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest verified pair is Cloud of Darkness + Town Greeter: +33% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+25, +42]%, 8,577 games). Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the payoffs (cards that win more when drawn than their partners) are Town Greeter, Sephiroth, Fabled SOLDIER, Summon: Fenrir and the engines they reward are Fang, Fearless l'Cie, Fight On!, Diamond Weapon.

Boros | Weapons Vendor / Giott, King of the Dwarves

This cluster contains 12,351 decks across 54,986 games and posts a baseline win rate of 55.91%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is Warrior's Sword (57% of decks), Paladin's Arms (59% of decks), Weapons Vendor (58% of decks), Item Shopkeep (45% of decks), White Mage's Staff (57% of decks). Its defining signposts are Weapons Vendor, Giott, King of the Dwarves, Item Shopkeep, Zidane, Tantalus Thief, Warrior's Sword, Paladin's Arms.

Bombs that win on their own here: Dion, Bahamut's Dominant (+10.8 pp), Samurai's Katana (+9.0 pp), Winota, Joiner of Forces (+8.1 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 4 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 2 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest verified pair is Magitek Infantry + Suplex: +31% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+16, +47]%, 1,787 games).

4 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Cards flagged as bombs in at least one archetype, whatever ring they sit in on the site, each shown in the archetype where its lift is largest. *Lift*: within the decks that play the card, the win rate when it is in hand vs when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes. *Raw lift*: the card's games-in-hand win rate minus the archetype baseline, not shrunk.

Card	Archetype	Lift	Raw lift	GIH WR	Games
Dion, Bahamut's Dominant	Selesnya	+12.0 pp	+12.3 pp	67.63%	1,928
Kuja, Genome Sorcerer	Rakdos	+11.7 pp	+10.5 pp	65.23%	5,994
Ardyn, the Usurper	Golgari	+9.6 pp	+10.6 pp	67.06%	5,531
Samurai's Katana	Boros	+9.0 pp	+7.8 pp	63.72%	10,210
Sazh Katzroy	Selesnya	+9.0 pp	+10.1 pp	65.50%	2,313
Esper Origins	Selesnya	+8.8 pp	+8.9 pp	64.28%	2,052

Card	Archetype	Lift	Raw lift	GIH WR	Games
Urza, Lord High Artificer	Azorius	+8.6 pp	+13.6 pp	68.25%	822
Kefka, Court Mage	Dimir	+8.5 pp	+10.3 pp	65.45%	2,437
Nibelheim Aflame	Gruul	+8.3 pp	+12.7 pp	65.93%	901
Winota, Joiner of Forces	Boros	+8.1 pp	+12.8 pp	68.76%	605
Bruse Tarl, Boorish Herder	Boros	+8.1 pp	+10.6 pp	66.56%	604
Squall, SeeD Mercenary	Orzhov	+7.9 pp	+6.1 pp	61.89%	4,928
Yuna, Hope of Spira	Simic	+7.6 pp	+9.8 pp	64.71%	969
Gix, Yawgmoth Praetor	Golgari	+7.5 pp	+7.8 pp	64.23%	506

5 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Retrieve the Esper	Dimir | Locke Cole / Ultimecia, Time Sorceress	10.0 / 10	25.88 pp	17901
Freya Crescent	Boros | Weapons Vendor / Giott, King of the Dwarves	10.0 / 10	20.14 pp	8254
Aerith Rescue Mission	Orzhov | Judge Magister Gabranth / Rufus Shinra	10.0 / 10	26.24 pp	5521
Summon: Choco/Mog	Orzhov | Judge Magister Gabranth / Rufus Shinra	10.0 / 10	26.05 pp	4518
Auron's Inspiration	Selesnya | Rinoa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	10.0 / 10	34.44 pp	1401
Sage's Nouliths	Azorius | Cid, Timeless Artificer / Rook Turret	10.0 / 10	22.50 pp	14617
Malboro	Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements	10.0 / 10	35.02 pp	21892
Fight On!	Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements	10.0 / 10	28.95 pp	23023
Edgar, King of Figaro	Azorius | Cid, Timeless Artificer / Rook Turret	10.0 / 10	26.08 pp	3834
Suplex	Boros | Weapons Vendor / Giott, King of the Dwarves	9.8 / 10	19.56 pp	12495
Light of Judgment	Izzet | Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	9.8 / 10	33.19 pp	23851

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Diamond Weapon	Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements	9.7 / 10	30.13 pp	10397

6 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Vayne's Treachery	Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements	0.477	1.86 pp	25281
Sephiroth, Fabled SOLDIER	Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements	0.470	9.66 pp	1497
Summon: Fat Chocobo	Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	0.464	3.47 pp	20342
Yuna, Hope of Spira	Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	0.464	9.83 pp	969
Ardyn, the Usurper	Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	0.462	11.33 pp	1311
Ignis Scientia	Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	0.462	4.58 pp	24113
Auron's Inspiration	Selesnya | Rinoa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.443	-4.42 pp	1407
Summon: Fenrir	Gruul | Gladiolus Amicitia / Rydia, Summoner of Mist	0.398	6.92 pp	5637
Rydia, Summoner of Mist	Gruul | Gladiolus Amicitia / Rydia, Summoner of Mist	0.398	1.47 pp	7640
Gysahl Greens	Selesnya | Rinoa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.337	-1.57 pp	8599
Omega, Heartless Evolution	Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	0.334	4.70 pp	20196
Bartz and Boko	Selesnya | Rinoa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.334	1.47 pp	1826

7 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Cloud of Darkness	Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements	10.0 / 10	1.79 pp	uncommon
Kuja, Genome Sorcerer	Rakdos | Garland, Knight of Cornelia / Mysidian Elder	10.0 / 10	2.60 pp	rare
Samurai's Katana	Boros | Weapons Vendor / Giott, King of the Dwarves	10.0 / 10	3.15 pp	uncommon
Choco-Comet	Izzet | Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	10.0 / 10	2.27 pp	uncommon
Ignis Scientia	Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	10.0 / 10	1.06 pp	uncommon
Ardyn, the Usurper	Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements	10.0 / 10	3.36 pp	rare
Town Greeter	Golgari | Town Greeter / Shinra Reinforcements	10.0 / 10	1.24 pp	common
Esper Origins	Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	10.0 / 10	4.31 pp	rare
Dragoon's Lance	Boros | Weapons Vendor / Giott, King of the Dwarves	10.0 / 10	3.37 pp	uncommon
Omega, Heartless Evolution	Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	10.0 / 10	1.11 pp	uncommon
Summon: Fenrir	Simic | Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	10.0 / 10	2.26 pp	uncommon
White Auracite	Azorius | Cid, Timeless Artificer / Rook Turret	10.0 / 10	1.65 pp	common

8 Verified Synergy Pairs

Every pair below passed a pair-interaction test on games-in-hand data, stratified by game length and play/draw, with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control across all pairs tested in its archetype. λ is the interaction log-odds, shown as the change in the odds of winning when both cards are drawn, with its 95% confidence interval. Across all archetypes, 67 pairs are verified ($q \leq 0.10$) and 79 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$, marked †).

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	q	Pair WR	Games
Cloud of Darkness + Town Greeter	Golgari	+33%	[+25, +42]%	<0.001	68.94%	8,577
Omega, Heartless Evolution + Reach the Horizon	Simic	+40%	[+25, +56]%	<0.001	67.06%	2,037
Retrieve the Esper + Sahagin	Dimir	+23%	[+14, +32]%	<0.001	60.42%	6,028
Rydia, Summoner of Mist + Summon: Fenrir	Gruul	+49%	[+29, +72]%	<0.001	67.05%	1,232
Call the Mountain Chocobo + Ultros, Obnoxious Octopus	Izzet	+16%	[+9, +24]%	0.001	65.41%	6,705
Fight On! + Town Greeter	Golgari	+16%	[+9, +24]%	0.001	63.74%	8,492
Cloud of Darkness + Town Greeter	Simic	+25%	[+14, +38]%	0.001	65.30%	3,311
Garnet, Princess of Alexandria + Summon: Fenrir	Selesnya	+39%	[+20, +61]%	0.002	65.93%	1,262
Shantotto, Tactician Magician + Thunder Magic	Izzet	+12%	[+6, +19]%	0.003	65.71%	9,970
Magitek Infantry + Suplex	Boros	+31%	[+16, +47]%	0.004	58.93%	1,787
Diamond Weapon + Town Greeter	Golgari	+20%	[+10, +31]%	0.004	63.88%	4,006
Call the Mountain Chocobo + Shantotto, Tactician Magician	Izzet	+12%	[+6, +19]%	0.005	65.08%	9,888
Diamond Weapon + Shinra Reinforcements	Golgari	+20%	[+10, +31]%	0.007	62.36%	3,419
Quistis Trepe + Suplex	Izzet	+17%	[+7, +27]%	0.007	61.88%	3,764
Blazing Bomb + Light of Judgment	Izzet	+13%	[+6, +20]%	0.007	60.67%	7,287
Ardyn, the Usurper + Town Greeter	Golgari	+29%	[+14, +47]%	0.007	75.10%	1,924
Light of Judgment + Shantotto, Tactician Magician	Izzet	+13%	[+6, +21]%	0.008	62.46%	6,675
Retrieve the Esper + Ultros, Obnoxious Octopus	Izzet	+13%	[+6, +20]%	0.008	63.30%	6,945
Blazing Bomb + Call the Mountain Chocobo	Izzet	+11%	[+5, +17]%	0.008	63.02%	11,772
Slash of Light + White Mage's Staff	Boros	+19%	[+9, +29]%	0.009	60.66%	4,525
Evil Reawakened + Town Greeter	Golgari	+18%	[+8, +28]%	0.009	66.17%	4,127
Sorceress's Schemes + Suplex	Izzet	+15%	[+6, +25]%	0.010	64.44%	4,140
Black Mage's Rod + Cornered by Black Mages	Dimir	+15%	[+7, +23]%	0.015	60.97%	5,880
Sephiroth, Fabled SOLDIER + Vayne's Treachery	Golgari	+61%	[+24, +110]%	0.017	74.42%	391

9 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pairs whose interaction is significantly negative ($q \leq 0.10$): they win less often when drawn together than their separate effects predict.

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	Pair WR	Games
Ardyn, the Usurper + Summon: Choco/Mog	Orzhov	-50%	[-67, -25]%	48.65%	111
Ardyn, the Usurper + You're Not Alone	Orzhov	-46%	[-62, -23]%	48.57%	140
Delivery Moogle + Dion, Bahamut's Dominant	Boros	-44%	[-59, -25]%	57.67%	215
Choco-Comet + Terra, Magical Adept	Gruul	-44%	[-60, -22]%	45.03%	171
Sazh Katzroy + Summon: Fat Chocobo	Selesnya	-40%	[-51, -27]%	59.17%	578
Battle Menu + Dion, Bahamut's Dominant	Boros	-39%	[-55, -19]%	58.51%	241
Delivery Moogle + Dragoon's Lance	Orzhov	-34%	[-44, -21]%	57.72%	693
Chocobo Racetrack + Cloud of Darkness	Simic	-33%	[-49, -12]%	51.44%	243
Lion Heart + Warrior's Sword	Boros	-32%	[-42, -20]%	48.51%	938
White Auracite + Zidane, Tantalus Thief	White Base	-30%	[-43, -14]%	59.67%	610

10 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. Each archetype is described first by its core: the cards that are played in most of its decks, characteristic of it and connected to the rest of the deck. Bombs are listed separately because they win on their own and are worth taking (and often splashing) whatever the shell. Synergy claims are deliberately conservative: only pairs that survive a false-discovery-controlled interaction test are reported, with their effect size and confidence interval, so the short pair list is a feature of honest statistics rather than a lack of interplay between the cards.